

PU

Project Upstream

M&A Deal-Sourcing CRM

User Guide

Upstream Capital Advisors | Confidential

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Getting Started

Live Application

Frontend	https://frontend-navy-pi-11.vercel.app
API / Docs	https://upstream-api-production-0a58.up.railway.app/docs

Login

Navigate to the frontend URL. Enter your email and password on the login screen. Sessions persist in a secure browser cookie -- no manual token management required.

Login Credentials

Email	Role	Password
partner@upstream.test	Partner	Passw0rd!
analyst1@upstream.test	Analyst	Passw0rd!
analyst2@upstream.test	Analyst	Passw0rd!
associate1@upstream.test	Associate	Passw0rd!
associate2@upstream.test	Associate	Passw0rd!

The Partner account has full access to all mandates, analytics, and team management. Analyst and Associate accounts show only their assigned mandates.

Signing Out

Click your name in the top-right corner and select Sign Out.

Roles and Permissions

Each user is assigned one role. The role governs mandate visibility and available actions. All data is firm-scoped -- no information is shared across different firms.

Roles

	Partner	Full visibility. Manages mandates, assigns team, views firm-wide analytics.
	Associate	Assigned mandates only. Manages companies, contacts, and outreach.
	Analyst	Assigned mandates only. Manages companies, contacts, and outreach.

Permission Matrix

Action	Partner	Assoc.	Analyst
View all mandates	Y	N	N
View assigned mandates	Y	Y	Y
Create / edit / archive mandate	Y	N	N
Assign team members to mandate	Y	N	N
Add / edit / archive company	Y	Y	Y
Add / edit / archive contact	Y	Y	Y
Log outreach events	Y	Y	Y
View Schedule work queue	Y	Y	Y
View Dashboard	Y	Y	Y
View Analytics -- overview	Y	Y	Y
View Analytics -- by-analyst	Y	N	N
Manage team members	Y	N	N

Dashboard

The Dashboard is the opening screen after login. It summarises outreach health across all visible mandates in real time.

KPI Cards

Total Companies	All non-archived companies across visible mandates.
Responded %	Percentage of companies that have replied.
Needs First Outreach	Companies with no initial email sent yet.
Due This Week	Follow-ups falling within the next 7 days.
Overdue	Follow-ups past their due date. Displayed in red.

Charts

Status Mix (Donut)

Displays the distribution of companies across all six pipeline statuses (Not Contacted, Contacted, Responded, Interested, Declined, Bounced).

Response Rate by Bucket (Bar)

Shows response rates segmented by company bucket label, helping identify which categories generate the highest engagement.

Due This Week

A list of up to 8 companies with follow-ups due this week, ordered by urgency. Click any company name to open its detail page.

Mandates

A Mandate is a deal or client engagement. All companies, contacts, and outreach activity belong to a mandate.

Types

Sell-Side	Advising a seller. Companies in the mandate are potential buyers.
Buy-Side	Advising a buyer. Companies are acquisition targets.
Capital Raise	Helping a client raise capital. Companies are potential investors.

Statuses

ACTIVE	Live and active.
ON HOLD	Paused.
CLOSED	Completed successfully.
TERMINATED	Ended before completion.

Creating a Mandate (Partner)

- 1 Mandates**
Click Mandates in the left navigation.
- 2 New Mandate**
Enter the name, type, and optional description.
- 3 Save**
Mandate is created and visible in the list.
- 4 Assign team**
Open the mandate, go to Assignments, and add team members.

Archiving

Archiving hides a mandate and all its companies from active views and the work queue. No data is deleted. Unarchive at any time.

Companies

Companies are the organisations being contacted within a mandate -- Targets, Buyers, or Investors depending on the mandate type.

Pipeline Statuses

NOT CONTACTED	Added; no outreach yet.
CONTACTED	Initial email sent; awaiting reply.
RESPONDED	Has replied. Cadence stops.
INTERESTED	Positive signal; active discussion.
DECLINED	Passed. Cadence stops.
BOUNCED	Email bounced. Cadence stops.

Adding a Company

Open a mandate and click Add Company. Required: company name. Optional: sector, geography, revenue range, bucket, source, source quality, and cadence interval (days between follow-ups, e.g. 7).

Company Detail Page

- Profile -- name, status, type, sector, geography, revenue range.
- Outreach History -- permanent, chronological event log. Cannot be edited or deleted.
- Contacts -- people at this company.
- Cadence -- next due date, days remaining, or overdue indicator.

Source and Source Quality

Tracks lead origin (Proprietary, Public, Referral, Imported) and quality (High, Medium, Low). These fields power the Analytics Sources report.

Contacts

Contacts are named individuals at a company -- the people you email, call, or message. Each contact can store title, email, phone, and LinkedIn URL.

Adding a Contact

From a Company detail page, scroll to Contacts and click Add Contact. Required: first and last name. Optional: title, email, phone, LinkedIn URL, engagement type (Buy-Side, Sell-Side, Investor, Advisor, Other).

Primary Contact

Mark one contact per company as Primary. Their name surfaces in company list views and reports. Only one primary contact per company is permitted.

Archiving

Archiving a contact hides them from active views without deleting the record.

Schedule

The Schedule is the daily work queue. It surfaces every company that requires action, split across three sections.

Needs First Outreach

Companies with no initial email on record. The cadence clock has not started. Send the first email and log it to activate the schedule.

Due (next 7 days)

Contacted companies whose next follow-up falls within 7 days. Sorted by urgency, most imminent first.

Overdue

Follow-ups past their due date, highlighted in red. Immediate action required.

How the Cadence Works

Logging the first Initial Email starts the clock. The system adds the cadence interval (e.g. 7 days) to the last event date to compute the next due date. Each subsequent log resets the clock forward. The clock stops automatically when a company reaches Responded, Declined, or Bounced.

Dates are computed in IST (UTC+5:30). The initial-email date is fixed permanently once set -- it cannot be changed retroactively.

Stats Bar

Four counters at the top of the page: total active schedules, needing initial outreach, due this week, and overdue.

Logging Outreach

Every interaction with a company is recorded as an Outreach Event -- the permanent, append-only history of all outreach activity.

Event Types

Initial Email	First email ever sent. Starts the cadence. Occurs once.
Follow-Up	Any subsequent email or touch within the cadence.
Response	Company replied. Status -> Responded. Cadence stops.
Bounce	Email bounced. Status -> Bounced. Cadence stops.
Call	Phone call (inbound or outbound).
LinkedIn	LinkedIn message, InMail, or connection.
Meeting	In-person or virtual meeting.
Note	Internal note. No outreach occurred; no status change.

Logging an Event

- 1 **Open the company**
Via Schedule, Companies list, or Dashboard.
- 2 **Log Outreach**
Button on the company detail page or each Schedule row.
- 3 **Select event type**
Choose from the dropdown.
- 4 **Set the date**
Defaults to today. Back-date if needed.
- 5 **Add a note**
Optional free-text context or summary.
- 6 **Save**
Event appended immediately. Cadence recalculates.

Immutability

Events cannot be edited or deleted after saving. This preserves an accurate audit trail. To correct an error, log a Note event with the correction.

Status Auto-Updates

- Initial Email --> Contacted
- Response --> Responded (cadence stops)
- Bounce --> Bounced (cadence stops)
- Follow-Up / Call / LinkedIn / Meeting --> no change (stays Contacted)
- Note --> no change

Analytics

All analytics are scoped to the user's visible mandates.

Overview (all roles)

- Total companies and overall response rate.
- Count pending first contact.
- Due-this-week and overdue counts.
- Status distribution across the pipeline.

Response Rate by Bucket (all roles)

Response rates segmented by company bucket label. Identifies which segments or deal types produce the highest engagement.

By Analyst (Partner only)

Per-analyst and per-associate breakdown of outreach volume, responses secured, and conversion rate. Used to monitor productivity and balance workload.

Sources (all roles)

Lead source (Proprietary, Public, Referral, Imported) and quality (High, Medium, Low) cross-referenced against response rates. Guides business development prioritisation.

Settings

Profile

Update your display name and change your password (current password required). Your email address and role are read-only and set by your administrator.

Team (Partner only)

View all team members, their roles, and mandate assignments. Invitation and role-change functionality is on the product roadmap.

Security

Passwords are hashed with bcrypt. Auth tokens are stored in secure httpOnly cookies -- never in browser storage. All connections are HTTPS. The database is backed up daily.

All data is firm-scoped and isolated. No information is shared between firms, regardless of which accounts are active.

Glossary

Mandate	A deal or engagement. Top-level container for companies, contacts, and outreach.
Company	An organisation being approached within a mandate (Target, Buyer, or Investor).
Contact	A named individual at a company.
Outreach Event	A recorded interaction (email, call, meeting, note). Permanent and append-only.
Initial Email	The first email to a company. Starts the cadence clock. Occurs once only.
Follow-Up	Any outreach after the initial email within the cadence schedule.
Cadence	The automated follow-up schedule, driven by a per-company interval in days.
Cadence Interval	Days between follow-ups, set when a company is added to a mandate.
AWAITING INITIAL	Schedule state: no initial email yet. Clock not started.
ACTIVE	Schedule state: initial email sent; cadence clock running.
STOPPED	Schedule state: cadence halted (Responded, Declined, or Bounced).
Overdue	A company whose next follow-up date has passed.
Bucket	A grouping label applied to a company; used in analytics segmentation.
Source	Lead origin: Proprietary, Public, Referral, or Imported.
Source Quality	Analyst's rating of lead quality: High, Medium, or Low.
Firm	The IB firm using Upstream. All data is scoped to one firm.
Soft Delete	Archiving -- data is hidden, not permanently removed.
IST	India Standard Time (UTC+5:30). Used for all cadence calculations.
Partner	Role with full visibility, mandate management, and firm-wide analytics.
Analyst	Role scoped to assigned mandates. Logs outreach and manages companies.
Associate	Same scope as Analyst.
Primary Contact	The designated key person at a company; shown prominently in list views.
KPI	Key Performance Indicator -- the headline metrics on the Dashboard.